LOCOTRADER

Trade Your Rules. Not Your Feelings.

LOCOTRADER

Investor Kit

Pre-Seed | $50K - $150K | SAFE Note

Prepared: July 2026

Founder: Erick Mafole

Status: Confidential

Location: Dar es Salaam, Tanzania

Contents

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

One-page overview for investor cold emails and first conversations

Company

LocoTrader - Mobile-first trading discipline operating system
Founded: 2024 | Location: Dar es Salaam, Tanzania (serving global market)
Founder: Erick Mafole (Solo founder, full-stack developer, active trader)
Stage: Pre-seed | Ask: $50K-$150K

Problem

73% of retail traders lose money - not from bad strategy, but from bad execution.

Revenge trading, FOMO entries, trading during personal dead zones, and ignoring position sizing rules destroy accounts daily. The existing market solution (trading journals: TradeZella, TraderSync, Edgewonk) is reactive - they tell you what went wrong AFTER you've lost money.

No product on the market prevents the mistake from happening.

Solution

LocoTrader is the first pre-trade enforcement app for retail and prop-firm traders.

Before a trader can enter ANY trade, the app's Gate System verifies:

- Session window (trading hours)
- Daily trade cap (not exceeded)
- Account lock status (no consecutive loss cooldown active)
- Setup proof requirement (chart screenshot or typed justification)

If any gate fails -> the trade is blocked. No override.

Additionally:

- Personal Edge Map: AI learns each user's specific patterns (profitable times, dangerous behaviors, symbol biases) after 30+ trades
- Prop Firm Drawdown Engine: Real-time tracking with auto-lock before account bust
- AI Trading Coach: Free, powered by Gemini, personalized to user's data

Market

Metric	Value	Source
Online trading platform mar.	$12.57B	Mordor Intelligence
Projected market (2031)	$18.18B (7.66% CAGR)	Mordor Intelligence
Retail investor share	69.59% of all trades	Mordor Intelligence
Retail segment growth	8.43% CAGR	Mordor Intelligence
Mobile trading orders	62% of retail orders	Charles Schwab (2025)
Prop firm traders (estimate.	2-3M globally	Industry estimates
Trader loss rate	70-76%	EU ESMA broker disclosures

Trading tools/journals TAM: ~$300M-$1.2B annually (based on 5-10M active retail traders x $5-10/mo tool spend)

Business Model

Phase	Model	Timeline
Launch	One-time lifetime deal (.	Month 0-3
Growth	Freemium + subscription .	Month 4+
Scale	B2B licensing + partners.	Year 2+

Unit economics target (post-subscription):

- CAC: < $5 (primarily organic)
- LTV: $80-160 (8-month average retention x $9.99-19.99/mo)
- LTV:CAC: > 16:1

Competitive Advantage

Feature	LocoTrader	TradeZella ($9.	TraderSync ($6.	Edgewonk ($12/.
Pre-trade enforcem.	[OK] Only us	[X]	[X]	[X]
Auto-lock on losses	[OK]	[X]	[X]	[X]
Personal AI edge d.	[OK] (free)	[OK] (paid)	[OK] (paid)	[!] (weekly sc.
Price	$0/mo	$35-99/mo	$22-60/mo	~$12/mo
Mobile-native	[OK]	[OK]	[OK]	[X]

Moat: Enforcement requires fundamentally different architecture than journaling. Competitors can't bolt this on without rebuilding their core product.

Traction & Milestones

Status	Milestone
[OK] Complete	Full product built (Flutter mobile + React .
[OK] Complete	572-trade personal dataset validating the t.
[OK] Complete	Gate system, Edge Map, Drawdown Engine, AI .
? Next	App store submission (iOS + Android)
? Next	First 200 waitlist signups
? Next	100 lifetime deal sales ($4,900 revenue)
? 12-month	2,000 MAU, $10K+ revenue, 30%+ Day-30 reten.

Use of Funds ($50K-$150K)

Allocation	%	Amount ($100K rais.	Purpose
Product development	40%	$40,000	iOS/Android polish.
Marketing & user acqu.	25%	$25,000	Content, community.
Infrastructure	15%	$15,000	Supabase, AI API c.
Founder salary (parti.	15%	$15,000	12 months runway (.
Legal & compliance	5%	$5,000	App store fees, pr.

Why Now

1. Mobile-first adoption: 62% of retail orders now on mobile - our native app matches behavior
2. Prop firm explosion: Estimated 2-3M prop firm traders globally, growing rapidly
3. AI cost collapse: Gemini AI is free (15 req/min) - impossible 2 years ago
4. On-device ML as market driver: Mordor Intelligence specifically identifies "on-device ML behavioral nudges" as a market growth driver
5. No incumbent in prevention: Every competitor is journal-first. We have first-mover advantage in enforcement.

Ask

$50K-$150K pre-seed for:

- App store launch and first 1,000 paying users
- 12 months of runway to prove product-market fit
- Target: 2,000 MAU and $10K+ revenue within 12 months

Contact: Erick Mafole - [email] | [Twitter/X handle] | [LinkedIn]

SECTION 02

Pitch Deck & Script

> *10-minute pitch deck narrative (12-14 slides)*
>
> *For in-person meetings, video calls, and recorded pitches*

Slide 1: Title

Visual: LocoTrader logo + tagline on dark background
Text on slide:

```
LocoTrader
Trade Your Rules. Not Your Feelings.

Pre-Seed | $50K-$150K
Erick Mafole | Founder
```

Script (15 seconds):

> *"I'm Erick Mafole. I'm a trader and full-stack developer from Dar es Salaam, Tanzania. I built LocoTrader - the first mobile app that physically blocks traders from entering bad trades. Let me show you why this matters."*

Slide 2: The Problem

Visual: Large "73%" stat + quote from a trader
Text on slide:

```
73% of retail traders lose money.

Not from bad strategy.
From bad execution.

 -  ESMA MiFID II Broker Disclosures (EU regulatory requirement)
```

Script (45 seconds):

> *"Under EU regulations, every broker must disclose the percentage of retail clients losing money. The number averages 73% across major brokers."*

>
> *"But here's what most people miss: these traders aren't using bad strategies. They know what support and resistance is. They know about risk management."*
>
> *"They lose because of execution: revenge trading after a loss, entering during personal dead zones, ignoring their own lot sizing rules, and trading on emotion instead of their plan."*
>
> *"In other words - the problem isn't knowledge. It's behavior."*

Slide 3: Why Journals Don't Work

Visual: Split screen - Journal (reactive) vs. Enforcement (proactive)
Text on slide:

```
Every tool on the market is REACTIVE.

Trading Journals tell you what went wrong  -  AFTER you lost money.

- TradeZella ($99/mo)  -  records trades
- TraderSync ($60/mo)  -  analyzes patterns
- Edgewonk ($12/mo)  -  reviews psychology

NONE of them prevent the next bad trade.
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"The market's answer to this is trading journals. TradeZella charges up to $99 a month. TraderSync charges up to $60. They all do the same thing: let you record a trade, then tell you what went wrong."*
>
> *"That's like installing a dashcam to prevent car crashes. It records the crash - it doesn't prevent it."*
>
> *"No product on the market today stops the bad trade BEFORE it happens."*

Slide 4: The Solution

Visual: Gate system screenshot showing blocked trade
Text on slide:

```
LocoTrader: Pre-Trade Enforcement

Before you can enter ANY trade, gates verify:
? Session window (are you in your hours?)
```

```
? Daily trade cap (haven't exceeded?)
? Loss lockout (not on cooldown?)
? Proof requirement (can you justify this entry?)

Gate fails -> Trade BLOCKED. No override.
```

Script (45 seconds):

> *"LocoTrader is fundamentally different. It's a pre-trade enforcement system."*

>

> *"Before a trader can enter any trade, they must pass through 'gates.' These gates check: Are you trading in your designated session window? Have you exceeded your daily trade cap? Are you locked out from consecutive losses? Can you provide proof - a chart screenshot or written justification - for why this trade meets your criteria?"*

>

> *"If any single gate fails, the trade is blocked. There is no override button. No 'I'll do it anyway.' The system says no."*

>

> *"This is the difference between a journal that records your failures and a system that prevents them."*

Slide 5: How It Works (Product Demo)

Visual: 3-panel product screenshots (Gate -> Edge Map -> Auto-Lock)
Text on slide:

```
1. GATES -> Block bad entries
2. EDGE MAP -> AI learns YOUR patterns (after 30 trades)
3. AUTO-LOCK -> 3 losses = 24hr cooldown (no override)
```

Script (60 seconds):

> *"Three core features make this work:"*

>

> *"First - the Gate System. Every trade must pass pre-set rules. This isn't a checklist you can ignore. It's enforcement."*

>

> *"Second - the Personal Edge Map. After 30 trades, our AI - powered by Google's Gemini, free tier - analyzes YOUR specific patterns. It finds your dead zones, your profitable time windows, which symbols make you money versus which ones bleed you, and behavioral patterns like stacking that destroy your edge."*

>

> *"Third - Auto-Lock. Three consecutive losing trades trigger a 24-hour account lockout. No override exists. This prevents revenge trading and tilt-driven decisions."*

>

> *"Together, these create a system where discipline isn't optional - it's enforced."*

Slide 6: Proof (My Own Data)

Visual: Data visualization from 572-trade dataset
Text on slide:

```
572 trades. 18 months. My own money.

Before LocoTrader:
- Stacking: 8.3% win rate (vs. 50% single entry)
- Dead zone 09:00-10:30: 23 consecutive losses
- EURUSD: 25% WR overall -> 54.5% on sells only

After building enforcement:
- Eliminated dead zone trading
- Stopped stacking
- Profitable.
```

Script (45 seconds):

> *"I didn't build this from theory. I built it from 18 months of losing my own money."*

>

> *"572 documented trades. My win rate was 32% with a 2.7 reward-to-risk ratio - mathematically profitable. But I was losing."*

>

> *"The data showed why: I was stacking entries at an 8% win rate instead of my usual 50%. I had 23 consecutive losses between 9 and 10:30 AM. I was trading EUR/USD in both directions when my edge was sells only."*

>

> *"Once I built the system to enforce these rules - gates, locks, restrictions - I stopped bleeding money. That system is now LocoTrader."*

Slide 7: Market Opportunity

Visual: Market size chart with TAM/SAM/SOM
Text on slide:

```
Market Size (Mordor Intelligence, 2026):

TAM: $12.57B (online trading platforms, 2026)
     -> $18.18B by 2031 (7.66% CAGR)
```

```
SAM: $300M-$1.2B (trading tools/journals segment)
     -> 5-10M active retail traders x $5-10/mo tool spend

SOM (Year 1): $10K-$25K
     -> 2,000 users x 5-10% paid conversion

Key growth drivers:
- Retail investors = 69.59% of trades (8.43% CAGR)
- Mobile orders = 62% and rising
- "On-device ML behavioral nudges" = identified market driver
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"The online trading platform market is $12.57 billion in 2026, growing at nearly 8% annually to over $18 billion by 2031. Retail investors represent 70% of all trades and growing at 8.4% CAGR."*

>

> *"The trading tools and journals segment alone is a $300 million to $1.2 billion annual market. Mordor Intelligence specifically identifies 'on-device ML behavioral nudges' as a named growth driver - which is exactly what we're building."*

>

> *"Our Year 1 target is modest: 2,000 users, $10-25K revenue. Prove the model works, then scale."*

Slide 8: Business Model

Visual: Revenue model timeline
Text on slide:

```
Phase 1 (Launch): One-time lifetime deal  -  $49
- 100-200 spots -> $4,900-$9,800 immediate revenue
- Funds development, builds user base

Phase 2 (Growth): Freemium + Subscription
- Free: Gates (3), basic calculator, 50 trades/month
- Pro ($9.99/mo): Edge Map, unlimited gates, AI coach
- Trader+ ($19.99/mo): Unlimited accounts, PDF exports, advanced features

Unit Economics Target:
- CAC: < $5 (organic-first)
- LTV: $80-160
- LTV:CAC: > 16:1
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"We launch with a one-time $49 lifetime deal - limited spots - to fund initial development and create urgency. After those sell out, we move to freemium with a $9.99 and $19.99 monthly subscription."*

>

"Because our acquisition is primarily organic - trading communities, social media, word-of-mouth - our CAC target is under $5. At an 8-month average retention, that gives us a lifetime value of $80-160

and a LTV-to-CAC ratio above 16:1."

Slide 9: Competitive Landscape

Visual: 2x2 positioning matrix (Reactive/Proactive x Expensive/Free)
Text on slide:

```
                REACTIVE <- -  -  -  - -> PROACTIVE
                    |
   Edgewonk *      |
   TraderSync *    |          * LocoTrader
   TradeZella *    |            (ONLY PLAYER HERE)
                    |
   EXPENSIVE  -  -  -  -  -  -  - + -  -  -  -  -  -  -  -  -  FREE
                    |
   Notion *        |
   Excel *         |

No competitor occupies the top-right quadrant.
We own "proactive + affordable."
```

Script (30 seconds):

"Every competitor sits in the left half of this matrix - they're reactive. They tell you what went wrong. Some are expensive - TradeZella at $99 a month. Some are cheaper."

>

"LocoTrader is the only product in the top-right: proactive enforcement at zero cost. No one else occupies this position because retrofitting enforcement into a journal-first architecture requires rebuilding the entire product. It's not a feature they can bolt on."

Slide 10: Why We Can't Be Easily Copied

Visual: Moat diagram
Text on slide:

```
Defensibility:

1. Architectural: Enforcement = different UX flow than journaling
   (Can't bolt "gates" onto a journal  -  requires redesign)

2. Business model conflict: Competitors profit from MORE trades logged
   (Blocking trades = less engagement for them)

3. Data moat: Personal Edge Maps trained on individual user data
```

```
   (More trades logged -> better AI -> stickier product)

4. Brand: First-mover in "trading enforcement" category
   (Category creation > feature competition)

5. Community: Africa-first, trader-built authenticity
   (Hard to fake with a VC-backed US team)
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"Our moat is structural, not just feature-based. Competitors can't easily copy this because their entire architecture assumes post-trade data entry. Adding gates requires rebuilding their core flow."*

>

> *"Moreover, there's a business model conflict: TradeZella profits when users log more trades. Blocking trades reduces their engagement metrics."*

>

> *"And as more users log trades, our Edge Maps get smarter per-user - creating a personal data moat that increases switching costs over time."*

Slide 11: Traction & Roadmap

Visual: Timeline with milestones
Text on slide:

```
DONE:
[OK] Full product built (Flutter + React + Supabase + Gemini AI)
[OK] 572-trade dataset validating thesis
[OK] Gate system, Edge Map, Drawdown Engine, AI Coach - functional
[OK] Pitch deck + investor materials

NEXT 6 MONTHS (with funding):
? Month 1-2: App store submission + beta program (20 users)
? Month 2-3: Public launch + lifetime deals (100+ sales)
? Month 3-6: 1,000 downloads, 30% D30 retention
? Month 6-9: Subscription tier launch, $2K MRR
? Month 9-12: 2,000 MAU, $5K MRR, seed-ready metrics
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"The product is fully built. Not a prototype - a complete app with every feature I described functional and working. That's unusual at pre-seed."*

>

> *"What I need funding for is launch execution: app store submission, user acquisition, infrastructure costs, and 12 months of runway to prove product-market fit."*

>

> *"The target: 2,000 monthly active users and $5K MRR within 12 months - which positions us for a seed round."*

Slide 12: The Ask

Visual: Clean, simple - amount + use of funds
Text on slide:

```
Raising: $50K-$150K (Pre-Seed)

Use of Funds:
- 40%  -  Product (iOS/Android polish, integrations)
- 25%  -  Marketing (content, community, micro-influencers)
- 15%  -  Infrastructure (Supabase, AI, cloud  -  12 months)
- 15%  -  Founder salary (12 months, Dar es Salaam COL)
- 5%   -  Legal & compliance

Terms: SAFE note (negotiable)
Target: 12-month runway to seed-ready metrics
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"I'm raising $50,000 to $150,000 on a SAFE note. The majority goes to product polish and marketing execution."*

>

> *"My burn rate is low - I'm based in Dar es Salaam where cost of living is a fraction of the US. This means your capital goes 3-5x further than backing a Bay Area founder."*

>

> *"The goal is simple: 12 months to seed-ready metrics. If I hit 2,000 MAU with strong retention and growing MRR, we raise a proper seed round to scale."*

Slide 13: Why Me

Visual: Founder photo + key credentials
Text on slide:

```
Erick Mafole  -  Founder

- Full-stack developer (Flutter, React, Node.js, Supabase)
- Active trader (572+ documented trades)
- Built the entire product solo  -  $0 spent
- Based in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania (low burn, high leverage)
- Domain expertise: I AM the target user

"I built this because I needed it.
I launched it because everyone else needs it too."
```

Script (30 seconds):

> *"I'm a full-stack developer who also trades actively. I built the entire product - mobile app, web dashboard, backend, AI integration - solo, with zero external capital."*

>

> *"This matters because I'm not building for a hypothetical user. I AM the user. I felt the pain. I validated the solution on my own money. And I can ship fast because I own the entire stack."*

>

> *"My location in Dar es Salaam means my personal burn is under $1,500/month. Your money goes to product and growth, not Bay Area rent."*

Slide 14: Closing

Visual: App screenshots + contact info
Text on slide:

```
LocoTrader
The app that blocks bad trades before they happen.

$12.57B market. Zero competitors in our quadrant.
Product built. Launch ready.

Let's talk.

Erick Mafole
[email] | [Twitter/X] | [LinkedIn]
```

Script (15 seconds):

> *"LocoTrader: a $12 billion market, zero competitors doing what we do, product already built, and a launch plan ready to execute. I'm looking for investors who understand that the biggest problem in retail trading isn't strategy - it's discipline. And discipline can now be enforced by software."*

>

> *"Thank you. I'd love to answer any questions."*

Appendix Slides (If Questions Arise)

A1: Technical Architecture

```
- Flutter (iOS + Android) - single codebase
- React + Vite (web dashboard)
```

```
- Supabase (auth, Edge Functions, database)
- Google Gemini AI (free tier: 15 req/min)
- Google ML Kit (on-device OCR  -  free)
- Hive (encrypted local storage)
- AES-256 encryption for backups
```

A2: Revenue Scenarios

```
Conservative: 1,000 users, 5% paid -> $500 MRR -> $6K ARR
Base: 3,000 users, 7% paid -> $2,100 MRR -> $25K ARR
Optimistic: 7,000 users, 10% paid -> $7,000 MRR -> $84K ARR
```

A3: Comparable Exits / Valuations

```
- Edgewonk: Private, est. $5-10M valuation (profitable, 10+ years)
- TradeZella: Raised $X (venture-backed, 100K+ users)
- TraderSync: Private, profitable, est. $10-20M
- Zerodha: $3.5B valuation (Oct 2025, Temasek investment)
- Comparable pre-seed: $2-5M post-money valuation typical
```

Pitch Delivery Notes

1. Total time: 8-10 minutes (leave 5 min for Q&A)
2. Energy: Confident but not hype-y. Data-driven. Match the "no-BS" brand voice.
3. Demo: If possible, live-demo the gate system blocking a trade (15 seconds)
4. Key moment: Slide 6 (your own data) - this is where credibility peaks. Linger here.
5. Close strong: "Zero competitors in our quadrant" - memorable positioning statement
6. Follow up: Send executive summary + one-pager within 2 hours of meeting

SECTION 03

Financial Projections

3-year revenue model for pre-seed investors

Conservative, Base, and Optimistic scenarios

Assumptions

User Growth Assumptions

Metric	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Launch month downloads	200	500	1,000
Monthly organic growt.	15%	25%	40%
Monthly organic growt.	10%	20%	30%
Monthly growth rate (.	8%	15%	25%
Monthly growth rate (.	5%	10%	15%

Revenue Assumptions

Metric	Value	Source/Rationale
Lifetime deal price	$49	Current pricing
Lifetime deal spots	100-200	Limited supply
Pro subscription (monthly)	$9.99	Below cheapest competitor.
Trader+ subscription (month.	$19.99	Still 3x cheaper than Tra.
Annual discount	35% off monthly	Industry standard
Free-to-paid conversion rate	3-7%	RevenueCat benchmark: fin.
Monthly churn rate (subscri.	5-8%	Finance app benchmark: 5-.
Average retention (months)	8-12	High-utility daily-use app

Cost Assumptions (Dar es Salaam, Tanzania base)

Item	Monthly Cost	Annual Cost
Founder salary	$1,250	$15,000
Supabase (Pro)	$25	$300
Google Cloud / AI APIs	$50-200	$600-2,400
App Store fees (Apple + Goo.	$8.33	$100 + $25
Domain + hosting	$15	$180
Marketing spend (Phase 2+)	$0-500	$0-6,000
Tools (analytics, email)	$0-50	$0-600
Total monthly burn	$1,350-2,050	$16,200-24,600

Year 1: Detailed Monthly Projections (Base Case)

Phase 1: Lifetime Deal (Months 1-3)

Month	Downloads	Cumulative .	Lifetime De.	Revenue (Mo.	Revenue (Cu.
1	500	500	50	$2,450	$2,450
2	300	800	40	$1,960	$4,410
3	375	1,175	30	$1,470	$5,880

Phase 1 Total: 120 lifetime deals x $49 = $5,880

Phase 2: Subscription Launch (Months 4-6)

Month	New Downlo.	MAU	Paid Subs .	Lifetime D.	Sub Revenue	Total Mont.
4	470	700	35	10 ($490)	$350	$840
5	590	900	55	5 ($245)	$550	$795
6	735	1,150	80	0	$799	$799

Phase 3: Growth (Months 7-12)

Month	New Downlo.	MAU	Paid Subs	MRR	Churn Loss	Net MRR
7	880	1,400	98	$979	$49	$930
8	1,060	1,700	119	$1,190	$60	$1,131

9	1,270	2,050	144	$1,439	$72	$1,367
10	1,520	2,450	172	$1,718	$86	$1,632
11	1,825	2,900	203	$2,028	$101	$1,927
12	2,190	3,400	238	$2,378	$119	$2,259

Year 1 Summary (Base Case)

Metric	Value
Total downloads	~11,700
Month 12 MAU	3,400
Month 12 MRR	$2,259
Month 12 ARR run-rate	$27,108
Total Year 1 revenue	$5,880 (lifetime) + $12,563 (subscriptions).
Total Year 1 costs	~$20,000
Year 1 profit/loss	-$1,557 (near breakeven)
Paid subscriber count (M12)	238
Conversion rate	7% of MAU

3-Year Summary

Conservative Scenario

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
End-of-year MAU	1,500	4,000	8,000
End-of-year paid users	75	240	560
Avg conversion rate	5%	6%	7%
End-of-year MRR	$750	$2,400	$5,600
Annual revenue	$10,000	$20,000	$50,000
Annual costs	$18,000	$30,000	$50,000
Net income	-$8,000	-$10,000	$0 (breakeven)

Base Scenario

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3

End-of-year MAU	3,400	12,000	30,000
End-of-year paid users	238	960	2,700
Avg conversion rate	7%	8%	9%
End-of-year MRR	$2,259	$9,600	$27,000
Annual revenue	$18,443	$72,000	$216,000
Annual costs	$20,000	$60,000	$120,000
Net income	-$1,557	$12,000	$96,000

Optimistic Scenario

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
End-of-year MAU	7,000	35,000	100,000
End-of-year paid users	700	3,500	12,000
Avg conversion rate	10%	10%	12%
End-of-year MRR	$7,000	$35,000	$120,000
Annual revenue	$40,000	$300,000	$1,200,000
Annual costs	$25,000	$100,000	$400,000
Net income	$15,000	$200,000	$800,000

Unit Economics

Per-User Economics (Base Case, at scale)

Metric	Value	Calculation
CAC (Customer Acquisition C.	$3-5	Primarily organic; paid s.
ARPU (Monthly, all users)	$0.67	MRR / MAU (includes free .
ARPU (Monthly, paid only)	$11.25	Weighted avg of $9.99 and.
LTV (Lifetime Value, paid)	$90	$11.25 x 8 months avg ret.
LTV:CAC ratio	18:1	$90 / $5
Payback period	< 1 month	$11.25 first month vs. $5.
Gross margin	85%+	Low infrastructure costs .

Why Margins Are High

- AI costs: Gemini free tier (15 req/min) covers most usage. At scale, $0.001-0.01 per query.
- Infrastructure: Supabase Pro ($25/mo) scales to thousands of users
- No broker integration costs: We don't connect to brokers (no data fees)
- Local storage: Most data stays on-device (minimal cloud costs)
- No human support at scale: AI handles coaching; community handles support

Path to Seed Round

Seed-Ready Metrics (12-18 months post-launch)

Metric	Threshold for Seed	Our Target
MRR	$10K+	$5-10K (Month 12)
MoM growth	15-20%+	20%+
Day 30 retention	25%+	30%+
DAU/MAU	15%+	17.5%
Paid conversion	5%+	7%+
NPS	40+	50+

Seed Round Estimate

- Timing: 12-18 months post-launch
- Amount: $500K-$2M
- Valuation: $5-10M pre-money (based on $100K+ ARR + growth rate)
- Use: Team (2-3 engineers), paid acquisition, broker integrations, expansion

Revenue Sensitivity Analysis

What Moves Revenue Most?

Variable	+1% Change	Revenue Impact (Year 1)
Monthly user growth	+1% (25->26%)	+$2,100 (+11%)
Free-to-paid conversion	+1% (7->8%)	+$2,800 (+15%)
Monthly churn reduction	-1% (6->5%)	+$1,400 (+7%)
Price increase ($9.99->$11..	+$2/mo	+$4,500 (+24%)

Insight: Price sensitivity has the highest impact. If retention proves strong, consider $12.99/mo (still below Edgewonk's $12.31/mo equivalent).

Break-Even Analysis

Monthly Break-Even Point

Monthly Burn	Required MRR	Required Paid Users (at $.
$1,500	$1,500	150
$2,000	$2,000	200
$3,000	$3,000	300

With $100K raise: 12+ months runway before needing to be cash-flow positive
Without raise: Need 150 paid subscribers to cover minimal burn ($1,500/mo)
Timeline to break-even (base case): Month 8-10

Risk-Adjusted Projections

Scenario	Probability	Expected Revenue (.	Expected Revenue (.
Conservative	30%	$10,000	$50,000
Base	50%	$18,443	$216,000
Optimistic	20%	$40,000	$1,200,000
Weighted Expected	-	$20,110	$286,000

Key Financial Risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Lower-than-expected convers.	Revenue 50% below projec.	Focus on activation metri.
High churn (> 10%/month)	LTV drops to $50	Invest in retention featu.

Gemini API price increase	Margin compression	Fallback to local-only mo.
App Store fee changes	-30% on all in-app reven.	Web-based payment option .
Slower growth (< 10% MoM)	Longer path to seed-ready	Double down on organic co.

Financial projections are estimates based on market benchmarks and assumptions stated above. Actual results may vary significantly. Conversion rate benchmarks from RevenueCat State of Subscription Apps (2024): Finance category median 2-5% free-to-paid. Growth assumptions informed by similar indie app launches in the trading tools space. Cost assumptions reflect Dar es Salaam, Tanzania cost of living and infrastructure pricing as of July 2026.

SECTION 04

Investor FAQ

> *Common questions pre-seed investors will ask, with data-backed answers*

Market & Opportunity

Q: How big is the market really? Trading tools seems niche.

A: The online trading platform market is $12.57B in 2026, growing to $18.18B by 2031 (7.66% CAGR) according to Mordor Intelligence. Retail investors represent 69.59% of all trades and are growing at 8.43% CAGR.

The trading tools/journals sub-segment is estimated at $300M-$1.2B annually (5-10M active retail tool users x $5-10/month average tool spend). This is a large enough market for a venture-scale outcome while being specific enough to dominate a niche.

Additionally, prop trading firms are estimated to have 2-3M active challenge participants globally (FTMO alone has 500K+ registered users).

Source: Mordor Intelligence Online Trading Platform Market Report (2026)

Q: Why do you think 73% of traders lose because of discipline, not strategy?

A: This isn't our claim - it's a regulatory disclosure. Under ESMA's MiFID II regulations, EU-regulated brokers are required to publicly disclose the percentage of retail clients losing money. The average across major brokers (IG, Plus500, CMC Markets, OANDA, Saxo) consistently shows 70-76%.

Academic research (Barber & Odean, "Trading is Hazardous to Your Wealth," 2000; and multiple follow-up studies) consistently finds that overtrading, disposition effect (cutting winners/holding losers), and behavioral biases - not poor market timing or technical analysis - drive losses.

Our own 572-trade dataset confirms this: a mathematically profitable strategy (32.4% WR x 2.71 R:R = positive expectancy) was unprofitable in execution due to behavioral errors (stacking, dead zone trading, FOMO entries).

Q: What if prop firms build their own discipline tools?

A: Prop firms optimize for challenge SALES, not challenge PASSES. A higher failure rate means more repeat purchases ($300-$600 per challenge). Their incentive is misaligned with building tools that help traders pass.

However, if prop firms DO want to offer this, we become a partnership/white-label opportunity rather than a competitor. Our B2B roadmap includes prop firm licensing.

Product & Technology

Q: Why can't TradeZella or TraderSync just add a "gate" feature?

A: Three structural barriers:

1. Architecture: Their entire UX flow assumes post-trade data entry. Gates require pre-trade flow - a fundamentally different user journey. It's not a feature bolt-on; it requires redesigning the core product.

2. Business model conflict: These companies profit from engagement (more trades logged = better retention metrics = higher perceived value). Blocking trades reduces engagement - directly conflicts with their business model.

3. Brand positioning: They've spent years positioning as "analytics tools." Repositioning as "discipline enforcement" would confuse existing users, require new marketing, and dilute their current value proposition.

This isn't a 6-month copy threat - it's a structural moat.

Q: What's your tech stack? Can you ship fast?

A:

- Mobile: Flutter (single codebase -> iOS + Android simultaneously)
- Web: React + Vite + TypeScript
- Backend: Supabase (auth, PostgreSQL, Edge Functions)
- AI: Google Gemini (free tier: 15 req/min, sufficient for early scale)
- OCR: Google ML Kit (on-device, free, no API key needed)
- Storage: Hive (encrypted local storage on device)
- Security: AES-256 encryption, biometric lock

I built the entire product solo. No contractor dependencies. I can ship features in days, not weeks. The full product is already built and functional.

Q: What happens if Google increases Gemini pricing?

A: Multiple mitigations:

1. The app runs in local-only mode by default (rule-based, no AI needed for core enforcement)
2. AI coach is additive, not essential - gates, locks, and calculators work without AI
3. Gemini free tier (15 req/min) handles significant scale before paid tier is needed
4. At scale, AI costs are ~$0.001-0.01 per interaction - margin impact < 2%
5. If pricing changes dramatically, we can switch to other providers (Claude, Mistral, local models)

Q: How do you handle data privacy? Traders won't want their data exposed.

A: Privacy is a core feature:

- Local-first: All data stored on-device by default (Hive encrypted storage)
- No broker connection: We never access trading accounts or execute trades
- No cloud required: Core features work without internet
- AES-256 backups: User-controlled, exported to their own storage
- Biometric lock: Fingerprint/Face ID on app open
- No data selling: Business model is subscriptions, not data monetization
- GDPR-aligned: User can delete all data at any time

Business Model & Revenue

Q: One-time $49 deal -> how do you make recurring revenue?

A: The lifetime deal is a launch mechanic, not the long-term business model.

Phase 1 (Launch): 100-200 lifetime deals = $4,900-$9,800 immediate cash to fund launch marketing and infrastructure. Creates urgency and initial user base.

Phase 2 (Growth): Freemium + subscription. Free tier includes basic gates and calculator. Paid tier ($9.99-$19.99/mo) unlocks Edge Map, AI coach, unlimited accounts, PDF exports. Lifetime deal users keep everything forever (cost of ~200 users is negligible at scale).

Phase 3 (Scale): B2B partnerships, white-labeling, premium community features.

The $49 x 200 spots = $9,800 is essentially a pre-sale that funds MVP marketing while building a base of power users who generate word-of-mouth.

Q: Isn't free pricing a problem? How do you monetize free users?

A: Free is a distribution strategy, not a pricing failure.

The free tier is deliberately limited (3 gates, 50 trades/month, 1 account, no Edge Map). It's useful enough to create habit formation (traders use gates daily) but limited enough that serious traders upgrade.

Benchmarks: Finance apps see 2-5% free-to-paid conversion (RevenueCat, 2024). Our unique enforcement features (Edge Map, AI coach, unlimited accounts) should push this to 5-10% because:

- The free tier creates daily dependency (gate habit)
- After 30 trades, the Edge Map "unlock" is extremely compelling (personalized insights)
- Prop firm traders managing multiple accounts NEED the paid tier

Even at 5% conversion, 10,000 free users = 500 paid x $9.99/mo = $5K MRR.

Q: What's your path to $1M ARR?

A:

$1M ARR = $83,333 MRR = ~8,334 paid subscribers at $9.99/mo (or mix of $9.99 and $19.99 plans)

At 7% conversion rate, this requires ~119,000 MAU.

Timeline estimate: Year 3 (optimistic) to Year 4 (base case).

Path: Organic growth + referral loops + eventual paid acquisition once unit economics are proven. The trading community is tight-knit - one viral "gate blocked my revenge trade" share can drive hundreds of downloads.

Q: $50-150K is a small raise. Why not raise more?

A: Three reasons:

1. Low burn: Based in Dar es Salaam, my monthly burn is $1,500-2,000. $100K = 50-66 months of runway (more than enough to prove PMF).

2. Less dilution: At pre-seed with no traction, raising $1M means giving up significant equity at a low valuation. Better to prove metrics on $100K, then raise seed at a much higher valuation.

3. Discipline: The product is about discipline. The company should mirror that. Raise what you need, prove the model, scale when ready.

Founder & Team

Q: You're a solo founder. Isn't that risky?

A: It's a valid concern. Here's why it's manageable:

1. Product is already built: The single biggest solo-founder risk (can't ship) is eliminated. Full app exists.
2. Full-stack capability: I handle mobile, web, backend, AI, DevOps, and marketing. No blocking dependencies.

3. First hire plan: With funding, priority hire is a marketing/community person (I'm weakest at sustained content creation). Tech I can handle solo through seed.
4. Low complexity: The product is well-scoped. This isn't a marketplace requiring both supply and demand - it's a single-user tool.
5. Long-term: Plan to hire 2-3 engineers for seed round (Year 2). Pre-seed is execution-focused, and I can execute alone.

Q: Why should you specifically build this? What's your unfair advantage?

A:

1. I AM the target user: I trade forex/indices with real money. I experienced the exact problem. I built the solution for myself first.
2. 572 trades of proof: Not hypothetical - I validated the thesis with my own capital and data.
3. Technical capability: Built the entire product solo - mobile + web + backend + AI. Ship speed is unmatched.
4. Geographic advantage: Dar es Salaam = low burn + authentic access to Africa's exploding retail trading market.
5. Domain + technical: Rare combination of active trader + full-stack developer. Most trading tools are built by developers who don't trade, or traders who can't code.

Q: What does the team look like in 18 months?

A:

Role	When	Why
Community/Marketing lead	Month 3-6 (with funding)	Content, social media, in.
Mobile engineer	Month 9-12	Scale feature development.
Backend engineer	Month 12-18	As user base grows, need .
Designer	Contract/part-time	Polish UI, create marketi.

Total team by seed round: 3-4 full-time + 1-2 contractors.

Growth & Competition

Q: How do you acquire users with no marketing budget?

A: Five channels, all organic:

1. Twitter/X trading community (35% of downloads): Data-driven threads from my 572-trade dataset. Trading Twitter is extremely engaged and content-hungry.
2. Trading Discord servers (20%): Active participation in 5+ servers, providing genuine value through risk management advice.
3. Reddit (15%): r/Forex (900K+), r/Daytrading (1.1M+), r/PropFirm - data posts that provide value first.
4. Word-of-mouth / referral (15%): "Gate Blocked" shareable moments - when the app blocks a trade, users can one-tap share to Twitter.
5. WhatsApp/Telegram groups (10%): Africa-specific trader groups, leveraging local founder credibility.

Post-product-market-fit (with funding): add $300-500/month in targeted ads to accelerate.

Q: What happens if this doesn't work? What's your plan B?

A: Honest answer - there are multiple pivot paths within the same thesis:

1. B2B pivot: If individual acquisition is too expensive, pivot to white-labeling for prop firms (they send traffic, we provide the tool).
2. Education platform integration: Become the "execution layer" that trading courses bundle with their curriculum.
3. Broker partnership: Offer as a free add-on to brokers (reduces their client churn -> they pay us per-user).
4. Data play: Anonymized behavioral data about retail trader psychology -> sell to prop firms, brokers, or researchers.

The underlying IP (enforcement system, Edge Map AI, behavioral tracking) has multiple monetization paths beyond direct-to-consumer.

Q: What about regulatory risk?

A: LocoTrader has minimal regulatory exposure because:

1. We don't execute trades: No broker license needed. We never touch user funds.
2. We don't give trading signals: No "buy EURUSD" recommendations. We enforce the user's OWN rules.
3. We don't manage money: Not an investment advisor or asset manager.
4. No financial data access: We don't connect to brokers or access account balances.
5. Classification: We're a productivity/self-improvement tool that happens to be used by traders - similar to a habit tracker or workout app.

The only regulatory surface is standard app store compliance (privacy policy, data handling) and basic consumer protection laws - which we already address.

Valuation & Terms

Q: What valuation are you looking for?

A: We're raising on a SAFE (Simple Agreement for Future Equity) with:

- Valuation cap: $1.5M-$3M (negotiable based on check size)
- Discount: 20% (standard)

Rationale for cap:

- Product fully built (not typical for pre-seed)
- Clear market with identified gap
- Solo founder with low burn = capital-efficient
- Comparable pre-seed caps in fintech/trading tools: $2-5M

Q: What's the expected exit path?

A: Multiple paths exist:

1. Acquisition by trading platform (most likely, Year 3-5): Companies like TradeZella, TraderSync, or larger platforms (TradingView, broker-owned tools) acquire for the enforcement technology + user base.
2. Acquisition by prop firm (Year 3-5): Prop firm integrates discipline tools to reduce challenge failure rates (and support costs).
3. Profitable standalone business (ongoing): At $1M+ ARR with 85% margins, the business is highly profitable as a lifestyle/SMB outcome.
4. Series A -> B growth path (Year 4-6): If unit economics support it, scale to 500K+ users and pursue larger fundraise.

Comparable reference: Zerodha raised at $3.5B valuation (Oct 2025, Temasek) - while they're a broker not a tool, it demonstrates the magnitude of outcomes in trading tech.

Q: Why invest now? What's the urgency?

A:

1. Category creation window: No one owns "pre-trade enforcement" yet. First mover wins this positioning.
2. AI cost window: Gemini free tier makes AI-powered features possible at $0 marginal cost. This window may not last.
3. Product complete: You're not betting on "can he build it" - it's built. You're betting on "can he distribute it."
4. Low-cost bet: $50-100K in a pre-seed with fully built product + low burn = extended runway + multiple shots on goal.
5. Pre-traction valuation: Investing now means lower valuation. After 1,000 MAU and growing MRR, the cap will be 3-5x higher.

All market data sourced from Mordor Intelligence (2026), ESMA MiFID II disclosures, competitor public pricing pages, and RevenueCat State of Subscription Apps (2024). Financial assumptions are estimates and actual results may vary.

SECTION 05

One-Pager

> *Print-friendly investor summary* | *Single page when rendered*

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?                                                                      ?
?   LOCOTRADER                                                         ?
?   Trade Your Rules. Not Your Feelings.                               ?
?                                                                      ?
?   The first mobile app that BLOCKS bad trades before they happen.    ?
?                                                                      ?
????????????????????????????????????????????????????????????????????????
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THE PROBLEM

73% of retail traders lose money (ESMA MiFID II disclosures).

Not from bad strategy - from bad execution: revenge trading, FOMO entries, trading dead zones, ignoring position sizing.

Every existing tool (TradeZella $99/mo, TraderSync $60/mo, Edgewonk $12/mo) is reactive - tells you what went wrong AFTER you lost money.

No product prevents the mistake.

THE SOLUTION

Pre-Trade Enforcement - Gates verify your rules before EVERY trade:

Gate	Function
Session Window	Are you in your trading hours?
Daily Cap	Haven't exceeded your limit?

Loss Lockout	Not on 24hr cooldown from losses?
Proof Requirement	Can you justify this entry?

Gate fails -> Trade BLOCKED. No override.

Plus: AI Edge Map (learns your personal patterns), Drawdown Engine (prop firm protection), AI Coach (free, Gemini-powered).

MARKET

TAM	$12.57B online trading platforms (2026) -> .
SAM	$300M-$1.2B trading tools segment
Growth	7.66% CAGR overall; retail at 8.43% CAGR
Mobile	62% of retail orders on mobile (Schwab, 202.

Source: Mordor Intelligence (2026)

DIFFERENTIATION

```
                 REACTIVE <- -  -  -  - -> PROACTIVE
     TradeZella *    |          * LocoTrader <- ONLY PLAYER
     TraderSync *    |
     Edgewonk   *   |
                 EXPENSIVE  -  -  -  FREE
```

Competitors can't easily copy - enforcement requires rebuilding journal-first architecture + conflicts with their engagement-based business model.

BUSINESS MODEL

Phase	Model	Revenue
Launch	One-time $49 lifetime de.	$5K-$10K
Growth	Freemium + $9.99-$19.99/.	MRR
Scale	B2B licensing + prop fir.	Enterprise

Unit Economics: CAC < $5 | LTV $80-160 | LTV:CAC > 16:1 | Gross margin 85%+

TRACTION & STATUS

- [OK] Full product built (Flutter mobile + React web + Supabase + Gemini AI)
- [OK] 572-trade dataset validating the thesis with real money
- [OK] All features functional: Gates, Edge Map, Drawdown, AI Coach, Multi-account
- ? Next: App store launch -> 1,000 downloads -> 2,000 MAU -> $5K MRR

PROJECTIONS (Base Case)

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
MAU	3,400	12,000	30,000
MRR	$2,259	$9,600	$27,000
Revenue	$18K	$72K	$216K

THE ASK

$50K-$150K pre-seed (SAFE note, $2-3M cap)

Allocation	%
Product development	40%
Marketing & acquisition	25%
Infrastructure (12 months)	15%
Founder salary (Dar es Salaam)	15%
Legal & compliance	5%

FOUNDER

Erick Mafole - Dar es Salaam, Tanzania

- Full-stack developer (Flutter, React, Node.js, Supabase)
- Active trader with 572+ documented trades
- Built entire product solo, $0 external capital
- Low burn: $1,500/mo (your capital goes 3-5x further than US founders)

WHY NOW

1. No competitor in our quadrant - first-mover in "pre-trade enforcement"
2. AI is free - Gemini enables AI features at $0 marginal cost
3. Product complete - investing in distribution, not development risk
4. Africa trading boom - underserved, mobile-first, growing fast

Contact: Erick Mafole | [email] | [Twitter/X] | [LinkedIn]

Market data: Mordor Intelligence (2026). Pricing data: TradeZella.com, TraderSync.com, Edgewonk.com (July 2026). Retail loss statistics: ESMA MiFID II broker disclosure requirements.